Luca Carbone

KU Leuven, Media Psychology Lab
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Employment

Hanover University of Music, Drama, and Media, DE 2025-2026
Guest Professor, Department of Journalism and Communication Research

KU Leuven, BE 2024-2025
Postdoctoral researcher, Media Psychology Lab

Harvard University, US 2024-
Fellow, Weatherhead Center, Cluster on Cultural and Comparative Inequalities

Education

KU Leuven, BE 2020-2024
Ph.D. Social Sciences - ERC project MIMIc
Winner best dissertation award, CAM division of ICA
Committee:
· Laura Vandenbosch (promotor)
· Steven Eggermont
· Giselinde Kuipers
· Tom ter Bogt
· Stef Aupers
· Michèle Lamont

Tilburg University, NL 2017-2019
M.Sc. (Res.) Social Sciences
Awarded best student, GPA 8.41/10, cum laude

University of Trento, IT 2014-2017
B.A. Sociology
GPA 28.74/30, 110 cum laude

Publications

Journal articles

2025

Carbone, L. (2025). Socio Technical Imaginaries of the Future among AI Pioneers (2005 – 2025). *SocArXiv*. https://doi.org/10.31235/osf.io/bpyj2_v1

Carbone, L., Klimmt, C., & Vandenbosch, L. (2025). The Internalization of a Performance-Oriented Self-Concept among Adolescents through their Favorite Music Artists. *Mass Communication & Society*. https://doi.org/10.1080/15205436.2025.2528630

Noon, E. J., **Carbone, L.**, & Vandenbosch, L. (2025). A Toxic Feedback Loop? The Relationship Between Performance-Contingent Self-Esteem and Toxic Communication in Adolescent Videogame Play. *Mass Communication & Society*. Accepted

Hubble, T., **Carbone, L.**, Vandenbosch, L., De Coninck, D., Toelen, J. (2025). Exploring parental intentions to use digital tools to enhance parent-child sexual communication: a cross-regional study in Europe. *JMIR Pediatrics and Parenting*. https://doi.org/10.2196/75489

2024

Carbone, L., Alvarez-Cueva, P., & Vandenbosch, L. (2024). Status Markers in Popular Music Across Six Countries: A Content Analysis of Gender, Race/Ethnicity, Genre, and Capital in Music Lyrics. *Sex Roles, 90*: 891–909. https://doi.org/10.1007/s11199-024-01483-0

Carbone, L., & Vandenbosch, L. (2024). Adolescents' Music Tastes in the Streaming Era: The Case of Belgium. *Cultural Sociology*, 1–21. https://doi.org/10.1177/17499755241244529

Carbone, L., Mijs, J., van Dooremalen, T., & Daedekindt, S. (2024). Towards a sociology of recurrent events. Constellations of cultural change around Eurovision in 18 countries (1981–2021). *Poetics, 104*, 1-13. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.poetic.2024.101889

Noon, E. J., **Carbone, L.**, Swinnen, B., & Vandenbosch, L. (2024). Adolescents' videogame play, need satisfaction, and self-esteem: A self-determination perspective. *Current Psychology*. https://doi.org/10.1007/s12144-024-05933-6

Hubble, T., **Carbone, L.**, Vandenbosch, L., De Coninck, D., Toelen, J. (2024). Exploring European parents' attitudes towards the age appropriateness of digital sexuality education for adolescents. *American Journal of Sexuality Education*, 1-25. https://doi.org/10.1080/15546128.2024.2415304

2023

Carbone, L. & Vandenbosch, L. (2023). A Meta-Analysis of Studies Examining the Effect of Music on Beliefs, *Communication Research, 51*(1): 1-28. https://doi.org/10.1177/00936502231163633

Rosič, Jasmina, **Carbone, Luca**, Vanden Abeele, Mariek, Lobe, Bojana, & Vandenbosch, Laura. (2023). Measuring Adolescents' Digital Well-Being in Everyday Life: The Perceived Digital Balance in Adolescence Scale, *Journal of Children and Media*. https://t.co/7KCSIGXBiW (among the most read papers on the journal's website with 604 views in August 2024)

Grusauskaite, K., **Carbone, L.**, Harambam, J., & Aupers, S. (2023). Debating (In) Echo Chambers: How People Read Conspiracy Theory Videos On YouTube, *New Media &*

Society. https://doi.org/10.1177/14614448231162585. Finalist in the ICA Popular Media & Culture division's Top Paper Award in 2022 (out of 229 total papers)

2022

Carbone, L. & Mijs, J. (2022). Sounds like meritocracy to my ears: Exploring the link between inequality in popular music and personal culture, *Information, Communication & Society*. https://doi.org/10.1080/1369118X.2021.2020870. Pre-print available here. Data, syntax, appendix, and pre-registration available on OSF. Trending paper in Communication and Sociology Altmetrics on 10th January 2022 OOIR

Rosič J., Janicke-Bowles S.H., **Carbone, L.**, Lobe B., Vandenbosch L. (2022). Positive Digital Communication Among Youth: The Development and Validation of the Digital Flourishing Scale for Adolescents, *Frontiers Digital Health*. https://doi.org/10.3389/fdgth.2022.975557

Book Chapters and Reviews

2025

Carbone, L. (2025). Film Review: 'FRONTLINE: GENERATION LIKE' and 'TIKTOK, BOOM', *Films for the Feminist Classroom* forthcoming.

Carbone, L. (2025). Book Review: 'Popular Music and the Rise of Populism in Europe (Eds. Mario Dunkel & Melanie Schiller)', *eExtreme* link.

2023

Kuipers, G., Brans, L., **Carbone, L.** (2023). "The myth of trickle down. How fashions do (not) spread in European fashion magazines, and what this tells us about power and status in the global fashion system" in *Fashion's Transnational Inequalities: Socio-Political, Economic, and Environmental* (Eds. Almila, A.-M. & Delice, S.). Routledge. link

2022

Carbone, L. (2022). Book Review: 'Getting Signed: Record Contracts, Musicians, and Power in Society (by David Arditi)', *New Media & Society*. https://doi.org/10.1177/14614448221101210.

2019

Carbone, Luca .2019. "Il mercato comunicativo su Twitter nelle europee 2019." " In: Valbruzzi, Marco (Ed.) *L'Italia sovranista e la sfida all'Europa. Le elezioni europee ed amministrative 2019* (56-63). Bologna: Istituto Carlo Cattaneo. DOI: 10.31484/2611-5778_41

Carbone, Luca .2019. "Twitter come mercato comunicativo? Un'analisi sulle europee 2019." In: Valbruzzi, Marco (Ed.) *L'Italia sovranista e la sfida all'Europa. Le elezioni europee ed amministrative 2019* (65-73). Bologna: Istituto Carlo Cattaneo. DOI: 10.31484/2611-5778_41

Awards & Funds

Best Dissertation Award, ICA ($250) 2025
(Children, Adolescents, and Media division)

Societal Impact Prize (Maatschappijprijs), KU Leuven 2025
(as member of the Media Psychology Lab)

Post Doctoral Mandate, KU Leuven (€80,000) 2024-2025

University of Chicago, scholarship & Dean's fellowship ($31,500) 2019-2020

Tilburg University, visiting fund at Exeter University (€1,000) 2018

Presentations

Conference Presentations

2026

We Want More: Music / Sociology! *(Rotterdam)*
Etmaal *(Wagenigen)*

2025

International Conference for an Inclusive Society *(Leuven)*
75th ICA *(Denver)*
Etmaal *(Bruges)*

2023

73rd ICA *(Toronto)*
Etmaal *(Enschede)*

2022

21st IASPM *(Daegu)*
Day of Sociology *(Groningen)*
72nd ICA *(Paris)*
Etmaal *(Brussels)*

2021

116th ASA *(Chicago)*
7th IC2S2 *(Zürich)*
4th Interdisciplinary Graduate Conference *(Tilburg)*
4th ISA Forum of Sociology *(Porto Alegre)*

2019

Day of Sociology *(Amsterdam)*

Invited Talks

2026

Music and youth mental health *(Music Matters, University of Groningen)*
Music and youth cultures *(Sociology Colloquia, Tilburg University)*

2025

Social media and youth mental health *(Cinema ZED – DOCVILLE, Leuven)*

2024

Cultural Sociology Club *(Department of Sociology, UvA)*
Music and social media *(Ancienne Belgique, Brussels)*
CII Spotlight *(Weatherhead Center, Harvard U)*
Culture and Social Analysis Workshop *(Department of Sociology, Harvard U)*
CII Seminar *(Weatherhead Center, Harvard U)*

2023

Current Research on Popular Music in Belgium *(IASPM Benelux, Leuven)*

Teaching Experience

Guest Professor

Hanover University of Music, Drama, and Media 2025–2026
· Course "Music and Youth Identity"
(MA Communication and Media Research & MA Media and Music)
· Course "Current topics in Popular Music"
(BA Communication Science)

Teaching Activities

Department of Communication, University of Vienna 2024
· Seminar "Music and Meritocracy"
(BA Communication Sociology)

Department of Sociology, Boston University 2024
· Seminar "Studying media objects and individuals' cognition"
(MA/PhD Sociology)

Media Psychology Lab, KU Leuven 2020–present
· Seminars "Computational methods for text analysis"
(MA Research Designs for Communication Science)
· Seminar "Music and the crisis of masculinity"
(MA Media and Crisis)
· Seminars "Music and the crisis of individualism(?)"
(MA Media and Crisis)
· Seminar "Social media: a curse or blessing for the body image crisis?"
(MA Media and Crisis)

Department of Sociology, Tilburg University 2017-2019
· Course "Social Risk and Culture"
(MA Sociology)

Department of Methodology & Statistics, Tilburg University 2017-2019
· Lab "Introduction to Statistics"

(BA Methodology & Statistics)
· Lab "Questionnaire Design"
(BA Methodology & Statistics)
· Lab "Experimental Design"
(BA Methodology & Statistics)

Supervising Activities

Daily mentor of **1 PhD student**, KU Leuven 2025-present
Supervisor of **12 MA students**, KU Leuven 2020-present
Supervisor of **6 research assistants**, KU Leuven 2020-present

Academic Service

Peer Reviewer

Journal for the Theory of Social Behaviour, *American Behavioral Scientist*, *Social Problems*, *Information, Communication, & Society*, *New Media & Society*, *Scandinavian Journal of Psychology*, *Mass Communication and Society*, *Cultural Sociology*, *Current Psychology*, *Journal of Media Psychology*, *Perspectives on Psychological Science*, *British Journal of Political Science*, *British Journal of Social Psychology*, *International Journal of Public Opinion Research*, *Nature - Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*, *Poetics*

Memberships

International Association for the Study of Popular Music (IASPM, 2022-2023), *International Communication Association* (ICA, 2022-present), *American Sociological Association* (ASA, 2021-2022), *Netherlands | Flanders Communication Association* (NeFCA, 2020-present), *International Sociological Association* (ISA, 2019-2020)

Affiliations

Fellow Weatherhead Center (Harvard University, 2024-present), *KU Leuven Digital Society Institute* (DigSoc, 2021-present), *KU Leuven Youth Institute* (2021-present)

Visitings

Department of Sociology and Weatherhead Center (Harvard University, 2024), *Department of Communication Science* (Yonsei University, 2022), *Department of Sociology, Philosophy and Anthropology* (University of Exeter, 2018)

Professional Services

Organizer "Communicating the Popular" pre-conference (Etmaal 2026),*National Representative of Belgium* (International Association for the Study of Popular Music), *Chair Popular Media & Culture division* (Netherlands and Flanders Communication Association, NeFCA, 2024-), *Chair session Meritocracy* (Alumni Conference Weatherhead Center, Harvard University, 2024), *Chair session Class and Status* (21st IASPM Annual Meeting, Daegu, 2022), *Presider session Meritocracy, Cultural Sociology Division* (116th ASA Annual Meeting, Chicago, 2022)

Faculty Services

AI Ambassador (KU Leuven, 2025-present), *Well-Being Ambassador* (KU Leuven, 2024-present), *Co-organizer Media Psychology Lab seminars* (KU Leuven, 2024-present), *Co-director of MethLab* (KU Leuven, 2020-present), *Co-director of Cultural Sociology group* (KU Leuven, 2020-2024), *Member Diversity and Sustainability Committee* (KU Leuven, 2021-2023), *Founder University newspaper "L'Universitario"* (University of Trento, 2016-2018)

Additional Research / Consultant Experience

External expert consultant for Canvas8 2025
Expert consultancy on music, fandom, and youth identities.

Research assistant at the Department of Sociology, Tilburg University 2019
(Supervisor: Prof. Ruud Muffels)
Research on basic income in the Netherlands.

Research collaborator at the Research Institute Carlo Cattaneo, Bologna 2019
(Supervisor: Dr. Marco Valbruzzi)
Political discourses on Twitter.

Research intern at Research Institute IRVAPP, Trento 2017
(Supervisor: Dr. Sonia Marzadro)
Evaluation of social policies for the European project Youth Guarantee.

Software

`chorrrds`: Music chords extraction - Collaborator
Available at: https://CRAN.R-project.org/package=chorrrds

Skills

Languages

Italian (Native speaker)
English (Full professional proficiency)
French (Intermediate proficiency)
Dutch (Elementary proficiency)
Spanish (Elementary proficiency)

Programming Languages & Softwares

Advanced: R, RMarkdown, Qualtrics, Mplus, Github
Intermediate: Python, HTML, CSS, Linux, HPCs
Basic: STATA, SPSS

References

Prof. Laura Vandenbosch (KU Leuven): laura.vandenbosch@kuleuven.be
Prof. Jonathan Mijs (Boston University): mijs@bu.edu
Prof. Christoph Klimmt (Hanover University of Music, Drama, and Media): Christoph.Klimmt@ijk.hmtm-hannover.de